THE KEEFE TEAM · JLA REALTY · ALEDO, TEXAS

Moving to Aledo & Parker County, Texas

Parker County is the first county west of Fort Worth, and it's where a lot of people land when they want room, good schools, horses or just a slower pace without giving up the city. Lisa has lived here for years and grew up moving with an Army family, so she knows what it's like to land somewhere new. Jennifer moved here from Missouri. This is the guide we wish we'd had: the towns, the trade-offs, and the questions to ask before you move.



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1. The lay of the land

Interstate 20 runs east-west through the county and is the spine of daily life. East Parker County (Aledo, Willow Park, Hudson Oaks, Annetta) sits closest to Fort Worth, with newer development and Aledo ISD. Weatherford, the county seat, is the historic center, with a courthouse square, Weatherford College, the hospital and the most services. North and west (Springtown, Peaster, Brock, Millsap) is more rural, with more acreage and longer drives.

The Brazos River forms much of the western edge, and Lake Weatherford sits just northeast of town.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Drive the county on a weekday before you fall for a listing. The distances feel different at 7:30 in the morning.**

2. The towns, briefly

Aledo: small-town feel, strong schools, Friday night football is a real thing. Newer neighborhoods, Walsh Ranch on the Tarrant County line, and pricier than the rest of the county. Willow Park and Hudson Oaks: along I-20, Aledo ISD schools, more shopping and restaurants, shorter commute, a mix of established and new homes. Weatherford: the full-service town. Historic homes near downtown, newer subdivisions on the edges, acreage all around, and you can get most things done without driving to Fort Worth. Springtown, Brock, Peaster, Millsap: smaller communities with their own school districts, more land for the money, and a true rural feel.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Ask us which town fits the life you want. We'll tell you the honest trade-offs for each, not just the good parts.**

3. Schools

Aledo ISD is the draw for many families moving in, and it covers Aledo, Willow Park, Hudson Oaks and parts of west Fort Worth. Weatherford ISD is larger and serves the county seat and surrounding area. Brock, Springtown, Peaster, Millsap, Poolville and Garner each have their own smaller districts, and families often choose a town for the specific school. Check the exact attendance zone for any address; district lines don't follow city limits.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Confirm the school zone for the specific address with the district before you make an offer. Don't rely on the listing.**

4. The commute

Downtown Fort Worth is roughly 20–30 minutes from Aledo or Willow Park on a normal day, and 35–50 from Weatherford. Lockheed Martin and the Naval Air Station on the west side of Fort Worth are closer, which is why so many of our neighbors work there. The Cultural District, the hospital district and TCU are reachable; Dallas is a real haul and most people don't do it daily.

Traffic on I-20 has grown with the county. If your job is east of downtown Fort Worth, test the drive at rush hour before you commit.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Time your commute from a real address at a real hour. Then decide.**

5. Houses, acreage and what things cost

You'll find everything from townhomes to historic homes to 50-acre ranches. In general, prices are highest in Aledo and east county and lower as you go north and west. Acreage is a big reason people move here, and it comes with things city buyers haven't dealt with: wells, septic systems, ag exemptions, deed restrictions and county roads. Our land and horse-property guides cover those in detail.

Property taxes are high in Texas (there's no state income tax), and they vary by school district and city. We'll give you a full monthly estimate on any home, not just the mortgage.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Decide early: neighborhood or acreage. It's the fork in the road for every Parker County search.**

6. Horses, 4-H and the outdoor life

This is horse country. Boarding barns, trainers, arenas, feed stores and veterinarians are everywhere, and the Parker County 4-H horse program (we help lead it) is one of the best ways for kids to get started. Lake Weatherford and the Brazos are close for fishing and paddling, and Fort Worth's Trinity Trails are a short drive. The Parker County Peach Festival in July is the big event of the year, and the Weatherford First Monday Trade Days have been going for generations.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **If horses are part of the plan, read our horse-property guide before you shop. Not every acre works.**

7. The practical stuff

Utilities: much of the county outside city limits is on co-op electric, private wells or water supply corporations, septic and propane. Internet varies by road, so check the actual address. Healthcare: Medical City Weatherford and a growing medical corridor, with Fort Worth's hospitals 30 minutes away. Shopping: Hudson Oaks and Weatherford cover the basics; Fort Worth for the rest. Airport: DFW is about an hour, and Fort Worth Meacham handles general aviation.

Weather is North Texas: hot summers, mild winters with an occasional ice storm, and spring storm season. Hail is a fact of life, which is why roofs matter so much on a showing (Jennifer's other company fixes them).

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Ask about internet, water source and septic on every house outside a city. Those three decide whether a place works for you.**

8. Moving from out of state

Texas has no state income tax, and your homestead exemption lowers property taxes on your primary residence once you file it. You'll register your vehicle in Parker County and get a Texas license within 90 days. Insurance is different here (hail and wind deductibles), so get quotes before closing. If you're coming from a state with lower property taxes, budget for the difference; if you're coming from California or the Northeast, your housing dollar goes a long way.

We can do video walk-throughs for out-of-state buyers, and we'll be straight about what a listing doesn't show you.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Relocating? We'll be your eyes on the ground. Tell us what you're used to and we'll tell you what's different.**

Why we're the right people to ask

Lisa restored her great-grandparents' farmhouse here and knows the county's history as well as its listings. Jennifer moved here as an adult and remembers every question she had. Between us, we've bought, sold, built and lived in the places you're looking at. Ask us anything.

Questions we hear most

Is Aledo or Weatherford better?

Different, not better. Aledo is closer to Fort Worth with a small-town-plus-great-schools feel and higher prices. Weatherford is the county seat with more services, more variety and more land for the money. We'll help you decide based on your commute, budget and how you want to live.

How far is Parker County from Fort Worth?

Aledo and Willow Park are about 20–30 minutes from downtown Fort Worth on a normal day; Weatherford is about 35–50. West-side employers like Lockheed Martin are closer.

Can I keep horses?

On the right property, yes, and this is one of the best horse counties in Texas. Deed restrictions and acreage decide it. Our horse-property guide covers what to check.

What's the catch?

Property taxes, I-20 traffic at rush hour, and hail. Everything else is why people move here.

Thinking about moving to Parker County? Tell us what you're looking for and we'll tell you where to start.

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